



Lanka TOURGUIDE

Embracing a Sustainable Future

Sri Lanka Travel News



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ANURADHAPURA' probably the next Sustainable Tourism HOTSPOT for Green Destinations Award



Isurumuniya Temple. Anuradhapura



Isurumuniya Temple is an ancient Buddhist temple in Anuradhapura near Tissa Wewa (Lake) Sri Lanka, famous for its rock-carved sculptures, including the iconic "**Isurumuniya Lovers**" and "**Elephant Pond**" carvings, built by King Devanampiya Tissa as a monastic complex. The temple features unique architecture and artistic marvels with both Buddhist and potential Hindu influences.

CLAUDE GUNASEKERA

The Sri Lanka government intends to nominate Anuradhapura for the next award by Green Destinations due to its alignment with Sri Lanka's national sustainable tourism certification program, which the Green Destinations Foundation is promoting with the Sri Lanka Tourism Development Authority.

While no official announcement has been made regarding this destination, it is being recognized Anuradhapura as a destination actively pursuing sustainability.

The ancient city is a potential candidate as part of a national push for sustainable tourism, but currently, Sigiriya is the only destination in Sri Lanka that has received a Green Destinations award.

The program acknowledges destinations that have demonstrated good practices in sustainable tourism and have a minimum level of compliance with the Green Destinations Standard.

By participating in this program, Anuradhapura is being recognized for its efforts and hard work in becoming a more responsible tourist destination.

Broader Context: This effort is part of a larger national strategy, the Sustainable Sri Lanka 2030 Vision, which aims to make Sri Lanka an economically prosperous, environmentally friendly, and socially inclusive nation. Anuradhapura's Potential: There are plans to develop Anuradhapura, along with Jaffna and Kandy, as "heritage cities" and promote the tourism industry in the district, including eco-friendly. **Officials in all nine provinces have been engaged in identifying potential destinations for future sustainable management, while proposing Anuradhapura could be one of the next focused destination.**

Lanka TourGuide | Sydney, Australia | October 28, 2025 | SLTPB Press Release:

Sri Lanka Tourism proudly showcased its vibrant offerings at Luxperience 2025, one of the most prestigious luxury travel trade events in the Asia-Pacific region, held from 7th to 10th October 2025 at the International Convention Centre (ICC), Sydney. The Sri Lanka Pavilion attracted exceptional attention from global buyers, luxury travel agents, and hoteliers, further strengthening the island's positioning as a premier luxury travel destination.

A total of 14 leading Sri Lankan travel and hospitality brands joined hands with the Sri Lanka Tourism Promotion Bureau (SLTPB) to represent the country at this event. The participating partners included Pepper Life (Pvt) Ltd, Flameback Eco Lodge, Uga, KK Collection, Transco Travels (Pvt) Ltd, Tour Blue Holdings (Pvt) Ltd, Aitken Spence Travels (Pvt) Ltd, Abercrombie & Kent, Magical Isle Holidays (Pvt) Ltd, W15 Collection, Wild Beach Resorts (Pvt) Ltd, Cape Weligama (Pvt) Ltd, Anantara Hotels and Resorts Sri Lanka, and SriLankan Airlines.

Representing the Sri Lanka Tourism Promotion Bureau (SLTPB) at the event were Chami Lanka Gasanwage, Assistant Director –

Sri Lanka Shines in Sydney Over 1,000 Successful Meetings Highlight Rising Demand from Australia

Marketing (Australia & New Zealand), and Darshana Charith Kaluthanthri, Assistant Director – Design, who professionally represented Sri Lanka Tourism and ensured a strong presence for the destination at this prestigious international forum. Throughout the four-day exhibition, the Sri Lanka delegation conducted over 70 productive meetings directly with travel agents, hoteliers, and tour operators. Including engagements between the participating Sri Lankan companies and international partners, the event recorded more than 1,000 successful B2B meetings, marking one of the most impactful international appearances by Sri

Lanka Tourism in recent years.

As per discussions held with Australian travel industry representatives, Sri Lanka continues to emerge as one of the most sought-after "hot bucket" destinations among Australian travelers. The country's diversity in experiences, from luxury resorts and wellness retreats to wildlife, adventure, and heritage, resonated strongly with the Australian market. Luxperience 2025 provided an ideal platform to strengthen trade relationships, explore joint promotional campaigns, and enhance visibility for Sri Lanka in the high-spending luxury travel segment. It also served as a valuable opportunity for Sri Lanka Tourism to gain market intelligence, analyze competitor strategies, and engage with new service providers for future global events.

Sri Lanka Tourism's participation in Luxperience 2025 aligns with its strategic mission to expand market presence in high-value segments and attract discerning travelers seeking authentic, sustainable, and luxury travel experiences. With the resounding success achieved in Sydney, Sri Lanka Tourism looks forward to building stronger partnerships with Australian tour operators and continuing its journey toward positioning Sri Lanka as a world-class luxury destination in the global travel map.



November 2025



Your Reading Fuels Our Passion

We are thrilled to share the incredible success of our newly launched tourism magazine, TOURGUIDE, in Sri Lanka. Your enthusiastic response and unwavering support have exceeded our expectations, inspiring us to continue delivering captivating stories, insightful travel tips, and vibrant visuals that highlight the natural beauty and cultural richness of Sri Lanka.

What makes this journey even more special is the widespread appreciation from readers across many countries around the world. Your positive feedback confirms that TOURGUIDE is becoming a trusted source of inspiration and information for travelers globally.

We extend our heartfelt thanks to each of you for embracing TOURGUIDE. Your encouragement motivates us to further elevate the magazine, showcasing Sri Lanka as a premier travel destination on the world stage. Stay tuned for more exciting content as we continue to explore and celebrate the unparalleled allure of this beautiful island.

Thank you for being a part of our journey and helping us make TOURGUIDE a beacon for travel enthusiasts worldwide!

Warm regards,
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CLAUDE GUNASEKERA



Arjun Deep Shad - Resident Manager & Keenan McKenzie - Area Manager SL, General Manager of ITC Ratnadipa

ITC RATNADIPA BEGINS THE SEASON OF JOY

ITC Ratnadipa, in Colombo has officially begun its Christmas festivities with the "Season of Joy", marked by a Christmas cake mixing ceremony and a festive tree lighting. This signifies the start of the holiday season at the hotel, a time of "warmth and festive cheer". It was the 2nd Annual Cake Mixing Ceremony held last weekend. The event, attended by a large number of distinguished invitees, marked the joyous beginning of the Christmas season with warmth, laughter, and the aroma of rich spices and dried fruits filling the air.

The ceremony was a glorious celebration of tradition and togetherness, where guests joined the hotel's culinary team lead in mixing an array of festive ingredients, symbolizing abundance, happiness, and good fortune for the season ahead. The event was beautifully complemented by an indulgent spread of food and beverages, bringing seasonal cheer to everyone's hearts content.

The evening truly set the tone for the holidays, as ITC Ratnadipa once again showcased its flair for grandeur and attention to detail. With

its elegant ambience, festive décor, and vibrant atmosphere, the celebration established a benchmark, ensuring that any forthcoming seasonal event will have to match the pomp and pageantry displayed by ITC Ratnadipa Colombo.

Speaking on the occasion, Keenan McKenzie, Area Manager – Sri Lanka & General Manager, ITC Ratnadipa, said "The Cake Mixing Ceremony is a cherished tradition that embodies the spirit of joy, unity, and anticipation for the festive season. At ITC Ratnadipa, we take pride in creating experiences that bring people together in celebration. This event marks the beginning of a truly special time of year, and we look forward to many more such joyous moments with our guests."

As the festive season unfolds, ITC Ratnadipa Colombo continues to promise a series of memorable experiences, fine dining indulgences, and celebrations that capture the essence of responsible luxury and heartfelt hospitality.

ITC Hotels has grown to encompass over 140 hotels across 90+ destinations, solidifying its presence in the Indian subcontinent.

ITC Hotels seamlessly blends India's rich tradition of hospitality with globally benchmarked services, offering a collection of hotels and resorts that reflect the unique culture and ethos of each destination. The group operates under seven vibrant brands: In the luxury space, ITC Hotels embody authentic, indigenous, sustainable experiences, while Mementos offer intimate and immersive experiences. The new EPIQ Collection presents a modern expression of premium Indian hospitality - blending culinary innovation, service excellence and design sophistication.

The Cake Mix in Action





Sustainability at the heart of everything at ITC

TOURGUIDE media platform was launched together with Sri Lanka Tourism Development Authority towards promoting Sustainable Tourism in Sri Lanka in association with the Sustainable Tourism Federation of Sri Lanka. The magazine promotes sustainable tourism as its prime objective. We feature tourism properties and allied ventures certified for sustainable practices and those actively engaged in Sustainable development under 'The Eco Odyssey' page. We find ITC operations are guided by a commitment to sustainability and responsible tourism practices hence we feature the role of sustainable tourism at ITC.

This philosophy has inspired innovative solutions that harmoniously combine world-class experiences with eco-friendly initiatives, ensuring a brighter and more sustainable future. With strong focus on renewable energy, water conservation and efficient waste management, our efforts have also been recognized through prestigious LEED Zero Carbon & LEED Zero Water certifications for multiple hotels. Responsibly Luxurious, Proudly Sustainable at ITC Two simple words, though rarely found

together, have become the bedrock of belief and commitment for ITC Hotels - Responsible Luxury.



Luxury most certainly, but luxury with a conscience.

Responsible Luxury is world-class luxury experiences which address the needs of wellbeing and safety through responsible practices which are in harmony with the environment and society.

ITC Hotels proudly leads the world with 9 LEED Zero Water Certified Hotels - a first in the hospitality industry. This milestone reflects its unwavering commitment to sustainable luxury and responsible water stewardship. ITC Hotels is the first in India to be recognized with the 2024 U.S. Green Building Council (USGBC) Leadership Award for Organizational Excellence. USGBC recognizes the leadership and commitment to creating a built environment that enhances health, equity, resilience, sustainability, and prosperity for all. Responsible Luxury is ITC Hotels' guiding ethos. This philosophy has inspired innovative solutions that harmoniously combine world-class experiences with eco-friendly initiatives. World's First Twelve LEED Zero Carbon Certified Hotels. ITC Ratnadipa Colombo has received LEED Platinum certification from the U.S. Green

Building Council (USGBC). This accreditation recognizes the hotel's commitment to sustainability through its design and operations, which focus on energy efficiency, water conservation, use of eco-friendly materials, and high indoor environmental quality.

LEED Platinum: The hotel was meticulously designed and constructed to meet the highest standards of environmental responsibility.

Energy and water efficiency: The hotel's design prioritizes energy and water efficiency to reduce its carbon footprint.

Sustainable design and materials: LEED Platinum certification acknowledges the hotel's use of sustainable site development and eco-friendly building materials.

"Responsible Luxury": This certification aligns with the parent company's (ITC Hotels)

"Responsible Luxury" philosophy, which integrates sustainability into all aspects of operations, say ITC Hotels. We believe that a better tomorrow starts with the changes we make today. This vision is brought alive by ITC commitment to sustainable practices, right from the structural design of hotels to their daily functioning.

India has been leading the tourist arrivals along with Europe and China. "We seek an experiential travel and not just a hotel room anymore. They are in need of customised experiences, exceptional customer service and a thirst for trying out something new and different. ITC Ratnadipa has positioned itself as a leading culinary destination with remarkable F&B outlets including Ahasa, the sky bridge, suspended 100 m above the clouds with its roof housing two infinity pools with a sky deck provides a unique design dimension," said Sujeet Kumar, General Manager of ITC Ratnadeepa adding the helipad is a unique feature that directly takes guests to the private Grand Presidential Suite. The spacious rooms with private balconies have all waterfront views. "Last but not least, the hotel will soon be launching its culinary loyalty programme that offers guests the best possible savings here in the city, and then, there's The Sagara (translating to ocean) lobby that showcases sweeping views of the Indian Ocean Kumar noted.

Sujeet Kumar



City of Dreams signals ambition to transform Colombo into a premier destination for entertainment in Asia.

CLAUDE GUNASEKERA



"Based on a vision set by Tourism Deputy minister Prof. Ruwan Ranasinghe to make Colombo as an Entertainment Hub in Asia; we the private sector hospitality industry will fully contribute towards achieving this vision by hosting multiple entertainment events in Colombo as part of our corporate objectives" Cinnamon Life CEO Sanjive Hulugalle told Lanka TOURGUIDE. He noted that Cinnamon Hotels in Colombo including Cinnamon Life have already commenced hosting a range of events in Colombo to boost tourism while supporting the government to reach its objective of making Colombo an Entertainment Hub.

City of Dreams Sri Lanka presented last weekend the 'Signature Diwali Glitz', a three-night extravaganza from 23 to 25 October featuring powerhouse performances and exclusive moments with South Asia's biggest stars. The spotlight shined brightest on Bollywood legend Suniel Shetty, who graced the grand finale on 25 October with meet-and-greet the guests and electrifying

Kathak fusion spectacle by the internationally lauded Kathak Rockers, blending classical rhythm with modern flair in a show that promises to mesmerize audiences.

The finale on October 25, promises to steal hearts of Suniel Shetty, a cinematic icon whose career spans over three decades and more than 100 films that lit up the stage. The arrival of Indian celebrities choosing Colombo as a destination of choice since the resort's opening is a testament to Sri Lanka's rising status as a cultural crossroad between South Asia and beyond. All artists stayed at the ultra-luxurious NÜWA at City of Dreams Sri Lanka which also highlights Colombo's luxury accommodation offerings.

Colombo is fast emerging as Asia's next entertainment hub, and for high-net-worth Indian travellers it holds irresistible appeal. With improved air connectivity, luxury infrastructure, luxury shopping, and a vibrant cultural ethos, Sri Lanka is becoming a preferred short-haul luxury escape.

City of Dreams Sri Lanka capitalises on this momentum — integrating world-class hospitality, performance venues, and headline talent to position Colombo as a magnet for elite experiential tourism.

Colombo prepared a spectacular stage, and Suniel Shetty, Nia Sharma, and Kathak Rockers brought that stage to life in Diwali's most dazzling embrace.

Adding a touch of sparkle to the celebration with appearances by Nia Sharma, a glamorous Indian actress and model widely recognized by the Sri Lankan audience as the lead of the hit Indian series Naagin Season 4. Renowned for her bold charisma and captivating performances, Nia performed the festivities in Colombo on 24 October, bringing her star power to the Signature Diwali Glitz. But it was on 25 October that stole hearts of Suniel Shetty, the cinematic icon whose career spans over three decades. Known for blockbuster hits such as Mohra, Dilwale, Border, and the comedy cult classics Hera Pheri and Phir Hera Pheri, Shetty's versatility,



charisma, and enduring star power make him a fitting centerpiece for the grand celebration. Diwali, the festival of lights and renewal, lies at the heart of this celebration. In that spirit, Signature Diwali Glitz brings music, dance, and cinematic glamour under one luminous roof.

Colombo is fast emerging as Asia's next entertainment hub, and for high-net-worth Indian travelers it holds irresistible appeal. With improved air connectivity, luxury infrastructure, luxury shopping, and a vibrant cultural ethos, Sri Lanka is becoming a preferred short-haul luxury escape. City of Dreams Sri Lanka capitalises on this momentum — integrating world-class hospitality, performance venues, and headline talent to position Colombo as a magnet for elite experiential tourism.

Sri Lanka's tourism vision is ambitious: to evolve into a premium destination for discerning travellers seeking more than eaches — a place of immersive culture, spectacle, gastronomy, and glamour.



A Weekly Sky-High Brunch Experience Cinnamon Life Launches Brunch

Cinnamon Life Launched a weekly sky high brunch experience on 23, and will continue every Saturdays. New Saturday brunch brings together signature dishes from a range of their specialty restaurants on Level 23.

Newly introduced Brunch is a new weekly experience that debuts throughout Saturdays. Hosted on Level 23 across Staten Bar & Grill and Bistro des Marées, the brunch offers guests panoramic views of both the Indian Ocean and Colombo skyline while sampling dishes from nearly all of the property's specialty restaurants.

The concept emerged from Cinnamon Life's first anniversary brunch held on October 18, which received strong positive feedback from guests. Following its success, the property has transformed the experience into a regular Saturday offering, continuing the signature Cinnamon approach to hospitality.

The Brunch bring together culinary highlights from Staten Bar & Grill, Bistro des Marées, Indiya, Yoroko, and Gatz, allowing guests to explore multiple cuisines in a single sitting. The format addresses a simple idea: rather than visiting each restaurant separately, diners can now experience the best of all the venues during one expansive brunch service.

The spread features distinct live stations showcasing each restaurant's strengths. Staten contributes a Meat Carvery with Beef

Wellington, Jerk Grilled Chicken, and Lamb Leg, alongside a German Station serving Pork Knuckle, three types of sausages, and pretzels with house-made mustards.

Bistro des Marées presents an Arabic Station with Chicken Shawarma, hummus, and fattoush salad, plus an Italian Station featuring Prawn Pappardelle and Truffle Mushroom Risotto. The restaurant also offers a Live Oyster Station with Café de Paris butter and garlic herb preparations, and an Antipasto Station with artisan cheeses, charcuterie, and fresh accompaniments.

Indiya brings authentic Indian street food through a Mumbai Chaat Station offering five varieties with traditional condiments, and a Keema Pav Station serving both mutton and vegetarian options. Yoroko contributes a Live Temaki Station and a Ramen Station featuring Shoyu and Miso variations with traditional toppings.

Gatz adds a Lamprais Station to the mix, presenting this traditional Sri Lankan dish with ghee rice, mixed meat curry, prawn sambal, and seeni sambal. The dessert selection includes Live Chocolate Taco and Crepe



Cinnamon Life – Level 23 Brunch runs every Saturday from 12pm to 3pm. The experience is priced at Rs. 12,000++ per person.



Suzette stations, an ice cream sundae bar, and seasonal Sri Lankan fruits.

A dedicated kids' buffet ensures younger guests have their own selections, making the brunch suitable for family gatherings, friendly get-togethers, or leisurely weekend starts. The relaxed, contemporary atmosphere across both venues provides flexibility for different group sizes and occasions.

Live cooking stations add theater and freshness to the experience, with chefs preparing dishes to order throughout service. The combination of seated dining areas with expansive city views creates a comfortable environment for extended Saturday afternoons.



**Exclusive Interview
with
General Manager
Dhinal Perera,**



Kandy Myst by Cinnamon, solidifying its reputation as a premier City Hotel

Kandy Myst by Cinnamon is emerging as a top City Hotel in Kandy. Its strategic location, facilities, and market performance point to its growing status as a leading city hotel. The hotel is a recent addition to the Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts portfolio.

The Kandy Myst shows a unique progress not even completing its one year of operation with a strong performance out of the gate, since its launch in February this year (2025). Its remarkable early success, with a steady increase in occupancy rates proves the point. The day we the TOURGUIDE team visited the hotel last weekend it was full. Its performance during the Esala Perahera festival, (July 30 to August 9) when it matched the occupancy of established competitors, further cemented its place in the market.

The hotel positions itself as a modern, upscale city hotel that redefines the experience in Sri Lanka's cultural capital. It caters to a wide range of travelers, from leisure and business visitors to solo travelers, couples, and large tour groups. The positioning is achieved through its contemporary design, superior quality, comprehensive amenities, and strategic location. The property is a blend of modern luxury and local charm combination featuring a contemporary design that still feels authentic to the Kandy experience.

Story-Anusha Maureen | Pix-Claude Gunasekera

Strategically located in the heart of Kandy, positioning for varied travelers. It offers guests' convenient, access to the city's attractions and features stunning views of Kandy. The location on Katugastota Road provides easy road access, offering unmatched convenience for both business and leisure travelers exploring the city and surrounding attractions appealing to both business travelers who prioritize convenience and leisure travellers looking for comfort. It is well-equipped to host corporate events and caters to large group bookings from local travel agents.

It's not just a quick "Pit stop" but rather a key destination for both food and accommodation. With 215 contemporary rooms it has the largest room inventory in Kandy. This allows it to comfortably accommodate large tour groups as it is their main focus. Kandy Myst has the largest capacity in the city, enabling it to host large tour groups. This scale, combined with Cinnamon's brand reputation, makes it a major player in Kandy's hospitality sector. The hotel has multiple dining options featuring a variety of F&B outlets, including the largest restaurant in Kandy, Grains Dining Restaurant, Terra Lounge and the Kosmos Skybar, which offers panoramic views of the city. Kandy Myst offers unique features that enhance the guest experience, with live music, and DJ nights. This makes it an appealing destination for both travellers and locals looking for a premium experience.

The hotel distinguishes itself from other hotels in Kandy. Most properties are older and reflect more traditional heritage. Kandy Myst offers a "fresh, vibrant stay experience" built to new,

International-Standard specifications, incorporating modern design and the latest safety standards.

It is known for its modern amenities, including a heated rooftop infinity pool and Guests have praised the hotel for its attentive service, cleanliness, and convenience.

Kandy Myst by Cinnamon is the first hotel in Kandy to receive LEED Gold certification under the LEED v4 BD+C rating system, signifying its environmentally friendly design and construction. The certification is a significant achievement, highlighting its commitment to sustainability. This uniqueness lies in its status highlighting its commitment to sustainability and modern eco-friendly design and attracts eco-conscious travelers and boosts its reputation.

The hotel saves 730 tons of CO₂e annually through the implementation of energy-efficient systems. Through rainwater harvesting and treatment, the hotel conserves 16 million liters of water annually. 30% of the hotel's site is dedicated to green spaces. During construction, more than 80% of waste was diverted from landfills. The hotel has fresh air systems that exceed standard requirements. The design incorporates elements focused on guest well-being. The property offers electric vehicle (EV) charging facilities.

Kandy Myst by Cinnamon is a joint venture between Indra Traders, which owns a 60% stake, and John Keells Holdings, which holds the remaining 40%. The hotel is managed by Cinnamon Hotels and Resorts, the hospitality arm of the John Keells Group.



OKTOBERFEST in the Hills



BlackCaps

Music that made the party go crazy

Prost! The "Oktoberfest in the hills" was held at Kandy Myst by Cinnamon during the last weekend from October 24th to 26th, daily 6:00 p.m. to 12:00 a.m. The event promoted a festive atmosphere celebrating German culture. The celebration featured German food, drinks, and live music, including traditional Bavarian fare, sizzling grills, and live music by the Blackcaps Band and DJ Tissa each night. Guests received complimentary draught beer upon arrival and enjoyed 15% off selected brews, pitchers, and spirits with free chasers. Many gathered to toast with friends and family at the event!





THASL launches First private sector digital destination campaign, 'Truly Sri Lanka'

Claude Gunasekera

New chapter in Sri Lanka's tourism revival, the Hotels Association of Sri Lanka (THASL) on Friday (24) officially unveiled its global digital marketing campaign designed to attract more international visitors and promote direct hotel bookings through innovative online platforms. Marking a historic milestone in Sri Lanka's tourism landscape, the first-ever private sector-driven digital destination campaign titled "Truly Sri Lanka" was launched by THASL.

Explaining the initiative, M. Shanthi Kumar, President of THASL, said, "Although tourist arrivals are increasing, cumulative earnings are showing a visible decline. We saw an urgent need to reposition Sri Lanka before further downturns in tourism earnings could occur. This is one reason we launched this campaign."

Shanthikumar said the association had been strongly advocating for a national-level global marketing campaign. "We are optimistic this will happen soon. In the meantime, THASL is taking proactive steps to position Sri Lanka in identified source markets and attract a higher-paying clientele to ensure sustainable growth," he said.

"We acknowledge that this campaign may not yield immediate returns, but THASL believes such efforts are vital to sustain momentum amid changing global dynamics," Kumar added. "Moreover, this initiative will complement and strengthen the forthcoming integrated destination campaign planned by the government."

A subcommittee chaired by Eksath Wijerathne, Vice President of THASL and Chief Executive Officer of Browns Hotels and Resorts, spearheaded the development of the campaign within just three months.

Given the rising cost and effectiveness of digital outreach, THASL adopted a digital-first strategy, selecting E Marketing Eye, a leading digital marketing company, to design and roll out the campaign across key online and social media platforms. Members contributing to the initiative will also have direct access to the "Truly Sri Lanka" website. The campaign is supported by NTB/Amex as the main partner and sponsor for the next three years.

The campaign, developed in collaboration with eMarketingEye — a leading digital agency — aims to strengthen Sri Lanka's brand presence in key emerging markets including Saudi Arabia, Jordan, Oman, Singapore, Malaysia, and Thailand. Additional destinations are expected to be included in the coming months. Supported by Nations Trust Bank (NTB) and American Express, the three-year initiative seeks to elevate Sri Lanka's image among high-value travellers and encourage year-round tourism. At its core is the landing page "Truly Sri Lanka", which connects potential tourists directly to participating hotel websites,

allowing them to explore offers and make direct bookings — enhancing both visibility and conversion for local hospitality brands. Founder and CEO of eMarketingEye, Rajitha Dahanayake, emphasized that the campaign targets nearby high-potential markets within a 4–5 hour flight radius. "Our research shows tremendous potential in these markets, and we want to attract travellers not just during winter but throughout the year," he noted.

The initial phase of the campaign, valued at around USD 50,000, will run over three months and is expected to position Sri Lanka as a preferred year-round destination.

Commenting on the partnership, Sheahan Daniel, Executive Vice President of Consumer Banking at Nations Trust Bank, said:

"Elevating tourism is of national importance. We are proud to partner with THASL in promoting Sri Lanka as a global destination."

As the main representative body for the country's formal hotel sector, THASL continues to play a pivotal role in shaping tourism policy. With members ranging from international hotel chains to boutique villas and lodges registered under the Sri Lanka Tourism Development Authority (SLTDA), the association represents over 70% of the tourism workforce.

By mid-2025, Sri Lanka recorded steady growth in tourist arrivals; however, a decline in average spending per visitor underscored the need to attract higher-value travelers. Through this campaign, THASL aims to address that challenge and ensure more sustainable returns for the industry — reinforcing tourism's critical role in foreign exchange earnings, government revenue, and employment.



THASL is the apex body of the entire hotel industry in Sri Lanka. It's membership presently stands at 200 hotels and resorts located in different parts of the country, comprising reputed International hotel brands, leading local hotel chains, proprietorships and stand-alone properties ranging from Colombo 5 city hotels to all other star categories including top end boutique properties.*

SriLankan Airlines brings home Silver Award for 'Best Sales Growth Strategy'

30 October 2025; Colombo – SriLankan Airlines has brought home the Silver Award for 'Best Sales Growth Strategy' at the prestigious Asia eCommerce Awards 2025, held recently in Singapore, firmly positioning the airline at the forefront of digital commerce in Asia alongside top global brands. The Asia eCommerce Awards recognise excellence in digital strategy and innovation, and winners are adjudged by a distinguished panel of industry leaders representing some of the world's leading organisations across multiple categories.

Gayan Wickrama, Senior Manager Commercial Services and Support at SriLankan Airlines, commented on the significant feat, stating, "We feel extremely honoured that our consistent efforts to keep pace with, and set the bar, in a domain that is continuously evolving have been rewarded. We strive to bring the best-in-class technologies to enhance the customer experience and make their journey with us as seamless as possible, while also supporting the airline's commercial goals. Over the past few years, we have successfully strengthened our contribution in this regard through a winning formula that focuses on precision in reach and added value to customers, and this recognition testifies to that."

SriLankan Airlines' digital business strategy has been successfully driving direct bookings and brand visibility, supported by Google Ads. The airline has leveraged Google's powerful 'Power Pair,' which targets high-intent search queries and expands reach using AI (Artificial Intelligence), enabling SriLankan to surpass key growth targets and enhance its digital footprint across global markets. In recent months, SriLankan also launched a contemporary, mobile responsive internet booking engine, complemented by an AI-powered chatbot that offers real-time, personalised assistance. Multiple automation initiatives have further strengthened funnel conversation rates, minimised friction and maximised engagement, reinforcing the

airline's commitment to optimising the booking engine's performance.

SriLankan Airlines' booking engine is accessible through over 60 localised landing pages and in more than 10 languages, offering a wide range of global payment solutions and making it a truly global digital storefront. These include Visa, MasterCard, American Express, Diners Club, Discover, Alipay, WeChat Pay and UnionPay. In Sri Lanka, customers can also enjoy the convenience of a pay-later option with fare guarantee or interest-free payment plans. Through planned integrations with global payment technologies, SriLankan Airlines is set to introduce a wider range of innovative and convenient payment options for its global customers.

Bookings can be completed in just a few easy steps, and customers can add multiple ancillary products to their shopping cart in addition to air

tickets, such as preferred seats, meals and additional baggage, allowing for a flexible mix-cart, single-purchase experience. Customers may also make self-service date changes to completed orders if required. Collectively, these initiatives have transformed www.srilankan.com into an award-winning booking platform centred on customer needs and commercial growth.

Photo captions1 – Bimali Malalasekara, Manager Digital Commerce of SriLankan Airlines (left), receiving the Silver Award for 'Best Sales Growth Strategy' at the Asia eCommerce Awards 2025 in Singapore.

2 – The SriLankan Airlines E-commerce team, whose consistent efforts led to the achievement of the Silver Award for 'Best Sales Growth Strategy' at the Asia eCommerce Awards 2025.

-Claude Gunasekera



"Elevate your journey - Fly high, fly safe"





Left: Jaffna Rail Station | Right Jaffna Dutch Fort

Jaffna - The land where the Yarl sings



MEDIA RELEASE by Sri Lanka
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Sri Lanka earns global
recognition in Lonely Planet's
"Best in Travel 2026" with Jaffna
recognized among the World's
Best Cities to Visit in 2026.

LONELY PLANET ANNOUNCES JAFFNA A BEST DESTINATION FOR 2026

The global travel media giant Lonely Planet announced its prestigious annual list of destinations under the "Best in Travel 2026" publication, naming Jaffna among the Best Cities to Visit in 2026.

This recognition marks a significant milestone for Sri Lanka, reaffirming the country's growing appeal as a diverse, authentic and sustainable travel destination. The selection of Jaffna highlights not only the city's cultural and historical richness, but also the success of Sri Lanka's continued efforts to promote its regional diversity.

Lonely Planet, the world's most trusted name in travel publishing, publishes the 'Best in Travel' series annually, celebrating 30 of the most inspiring destinations across the globe. The destinations are chosen by Lonely Planet's network of editors, writers and travel experts, focusing on innovation, sustainability and unique visitor experiences. Every year these expert analysts explore the most remote areas of the world in search for unparalleled locations to include in 'Best in Travel' list. The Italian-language edition of Lonely Planet's Best in Travel 2026 was officially unveiled on 22 October 2025 at a high-profile press event held at Identità Golose Milano, organized by Lonely Planet Italia. The event was attended by Italian mainstream media representatives, travel influencers, content creators, tour operators and industry professionals from across Italy. Representing 'Sri Lanka Tourism',



the Consulate General of Sri Lanka in Milan contributed to the occasion by offering a selection of signature dishes from Jaffna for the luncheon that followed the event and by arranging a guest speech introducing the destination during the press briefing. This recognition is expected to contribute significantly to enhancing Sri Lanka's tourism visibility in the international tourism arena. It also serves as a valuable endorsement for the country's ongoing efforts to promote regional tourism development and community-based



travel experiences in lesser-known destinations.

As one of the world's most trusted and influential travel media brands, Lonely Planet's recommendations reach millions of readers, travellers and industry professionals across both digital and print platforms. Inclusion in the Best in Travel list not only validates the destination's unique attractions, authenticity and visitor experience, but also serves as a powerful marketing endorsement that can boost tourist arrivals, strengthen brand positioning and attract new partnerships within the global travel industry.

Representing Sri Lanka Tourism, the Consul General of Sri Lanka in Milan Dulmith Waruna and the Minister Counsellor (Commercial) Ms. Tharaka Botheju, graced the official ceremony held in Italy targeting the Italian travellers and tour operators.





Sri Lanka won the Bronze Award for Sigiriya, Sri Lanka among many other destinations in the world at the ITB Berlin travel fair in early this year (March 2025). It was presented by Green

Destination's an international body that recognizes sustainable tourism practices. This award recognizes Sigiriya's excellence in sustainable tourism, including its efforts in nature conservation, heritage preservation, waste management, energy efficiency, and climate action. It is a significant achievement for Sri Lanka, highlighting the country's commitment to eco-friendly tourism and its potential as a sustainable destination. This award is a milestone for Sri Lanka's tourism industry, positioning as a leader in sustainable and responsible travel and encouraging more eco-friendly practices across the country.

ANURADHAPURA

For Next Green Destination Award

The Tourism vision of the government is to position Sri Lanka as a "Green island" destination, which supports the idea of developing locations like Anuradhapura, a culturally significant site. While there is no specific official announcement that Anuradhapura will be developed for the next Green Destination award, the Chairman of Sri Lanka Tourism Development Authority (SLTDA) Buddhika Hewawasam shows an interest towards this aim. It is likely that Anuradhapura, with its historical significance, could be a nomination for Green Destinations Award in the future.

However, SLTDA is actively working to develop sustainable tourism destinations around Sri Lanka in every province. The SLTDA held a workshop in May 2025, headed by Upali Rathnayake, former Deputy Director General / Head of Sustainable Tourism Unit along with Muditha Abeysinghe Senior Manager and Rajeeeka Ranathunga Assistant Director at SLTDA to identify potential locations for sustainable tourism development across all nine provinces. SLTDA efforts are focused on its many offshore destinations.

The SLTDA together with senior representatives of the government attended from all 9 provinces arrived at a consensus with a firm goal to develop at least one sustainable destination in each province. This initiative began after a workshop with provincial tourism officers in May 2025, where potential destinations were identified.

Anuradhapura

Anuradhapura is considered the cradle of Buddhism in Sri Lanka and played a pivotal role in its development. The historical value of Anuradhapura lies in its role as Sri Lanka's first and longest-serving capital for nearly 1,500 years, from the 5th century BCE to the 11th century CE making it a cradle of Sinhalese civilization, politics, and religion. It was the main cultural and economic center of ancient Sri Lanka for centuries, housing the royal residence for numerous Sinhalese kings. The city is home to the Sri Maha Bodhi, a sacred fig tree considered a sapling from the original Bodhi tree under which Buddha attained enlightenment. It is one of the world's oldest documented planted trees.

The introduction of Buddhism during the Anuradhapura period significantly influenced the society, laws, and governance of the kingdom.

Today, its archaeological significance is recognized by UNESCO. The ancient city is one of Sri Lanka's eight UNESCO World Heritage Sites, recognized for its historical, cultural, and religious significance. The city is a focal point for UNESCO initiatives aimed at

The city is a major archaeological and spiritual hub, drawing international attention for conservation and cultural preservation efforts. Culture and heritage.

The government is focusing on restoring Anuradhapura to its "ancient glory," with support from the Indian government. Sri Lankan Prime Minister Dr. Harini Amarasuriya emphasized Anuradhapura's universal value during the UNESCO summit, highlighting the need for sustainable conservation strategies.

During the Poson Festival in June 2025, President Anura Kumara Dissanayake spoke of the importance of preserving the region's spiritual and cultural heritage.

- Anusha Maureen



long-term preservation of its World Heritage status. It contains the ruins of an extensive ancient city, including palaces, monasteries, impressive stupas (like the Jetavanaramaya), and sophisticated irrigation systems. The site showcases remarkable stone sculptures, such as guardstones (muragala) and moonstones, that provide valuable insights into the beliefs and artistic traditions of the time.



SRI LANKA SHOULD AIM FOR MORE MICHELIN KEYS TO ELEVATE ITS LUXURY

By Suresh Abbas

General Manager, Galle Face Hotel

“Sri Lanka has immense natural and cultural potential, but we need to invest more strategically in infrastructure, accessibility, and service standards if we are to attract the high-value luxury traveler”.



In the recent lists of Top Luxury Hotels declared by various organisations very rarely we see a Sri Lankan property in such lists. It was recently found that Aman represents Sri Lanka. Meanwhile, Indonesia features number of hotels among top 30 hotels that are independently owned, yet deliver exceptional luxury and world-class guest experiences. Guests who spend over \$500 per night are not only looking for comfort — they seek rare, authentic, and seamless experiences. Imagine an itinerary where a traveller witnesses blue whales at sunrise, sees Asian elephants by day, and spots a Sri Lankan leopard by afternoon — all in a single day. This is not just a holiday; it's a continent of experiences within one island. To realise this vision, Sri Lanka must:

- Encourage hotels and resorts to strive for Michelin Key recognition, raising global awareness of our hospitality excellence.
- Develop air taxi connectivity and regional transport links to connect wildlife, culture, and coastline fortlessly.
- Support independent hotel owners in elevating design, service, and sustainability standards to compete globally. Sri Lanka offers an unmatched diversity of experiences — from heritage to wildlife, from ocean to highlands. It's time we create the infrastructure and recognition that allows the world to see it as a luxury destination on par with the best in Asia.



Michelin Keys are a hotel rating system that recognizes outstanding hotels, similar to Michelin Stars for restaurants. The keys are awarded to hotels that excel in categories like design, architecture, service, and personality, based on anonymous inspections. A One Key signifies a special stay, a Two Key denotes an exceptional and unique stay, and Three Keys represent an extraordinary and top-class experience.

Michelin Key ratings

- One Michelin Key:** A special stay. Highlights hotels with a unique character and personality. Offers a high level of comfort and service that stands out in its price range.
- Two Michelin Keys:** An exceptional stay. Indicates a unique, memorable, and exceptional experience. Features outstanding design, architecture, and local charm.
- Three Michelin Keys:** An extraordinary, top-class stay. Recognizes the most remarkable and superlative hotels in the world.

Denotes the highest level of hospitality, service, comfort, and style.

- Criteria for awarding keys
- Excellence in architecture and interior design
 - Quality and consistency of service
 - Overall personality and character
 - Value for the price
 - Significant contribution to the neighborhood or setting



The list of The World's 50 Best Hotels 2025 was revealed at a live awards ceremony in London on Thursday 30 October (2025). The top 5 are;

- No. 1: Rosewood, Hong Kong
- No. 2: Four Seasons Bangkok at Chao Phraya River, Bangkok
- No. 3: Capella Bangkok, Bangkok
- No. 4: Raffles Singapore, Singapore
- No. 5: Passalacqua, Lake Como

- No.50 Mandapa, Bali Indonesia
- No.49 Hotel Sacher Vienna
- No.48 Grand Park Hotel Rovinj
- No.47 Estelle Manor
- No.46 Hotel The Mitsui
- No.45 The Tokyo Edition Toranomon
- No.44 Las Ventanas al Paraíso –Los Cabos
- No.43 The Mark –New York
- No.42 Hotel Bel-Air, Los Angeles
- No.41 Mandarin Oriental Hong Kong
- No.40 Singita – Kruger National Park
- No.39 One&Only Mandarina Riviera Nayarit
- No.38 The Taj Mahal Palace Mumbai
- No.37 Janu Tokyo
- No.36 Hôtel de Paris Monte-Carlo Monaco
- No.35 The Lana Dubai
- No.34 The Calile, Brisbane
- No.33 Maroma Riviera Maya
- No.32 The Emory –London
- No.31 Raffles London at The OWO London
- No.30 La Mamounia Marrakech
- No.29 The Connaught London
- No.28 Soneva Fushi Maldives
- No.27 Hôtel du Couvent – Nice
- No.26 Hotel Il Pellicano –Porto Ercole
- No.25 Aman Tokyo
- No.24 Rosewood São Paulo São Paulo
- No.23 Hôtel de Crillon Paris
- No.22 Bulgari Roma –Rome
- No.21 Cheval Blanc Paris
- No.20 Jumeirah Marsa Al Arab – Dubai
- No.19 Le Bristol Paris
- No.18 Desa Potato Head Bali
- No.17 Four Seasons Astir Palace Athens
- No.16 Claridge's London
- No.15 Bulgari Tokyo
- No.14 Mandarin Oriental Qianmen Beijing
- No.13 Royal Mansour Marrakech
- No.12 Capella Sydney – Sydney
- No.11 Copacabana Palace Rio de Janeiro
- No.10 Upper House Hong Kong
- No.9 Four Seasons Firenze
- No.8 Chablé Yucatán Chocholá
- No.7 Mandarin Oriental Bangkok
- No.6 Atlantis The Royal Dubai

Dancing through the Decades New Year's Eve at Cinnamon Life



Wednesday 29 October, Colombo | www.lankatourguide.lk – It's the night everyone's been waiting for! This 31st December, the city's heartbeat will be at one address — Cinnamon Life, the Entertainment Capital of Colombo — where the Lumina Ballroom transforms into a glittering time machine for "Dancing through the Decades", an unforgettable New Year's Eve celebration that promises to keep you grooving well into 2026!

Hosted by the ever-charming Kumar de Silva, this one-of-a-kind soirée takes guests on a vibrant journey through music's greatest eras, from the electric 80s to the rhythmic 90s and iconic 2000s. It is nostalgia with a neon twist, where disco balls meet digital beats and timeless classics collide with fresh sounds. Headlining the night is the legendary Sohan Weerasinghe, whose commanding stage presence will set the tone for an evening

bursting with rhythm and flair. Sharing the spotlight are some of Sri Lanka's most celebrated performers — powerhouse diva Corrine Almeida, the effortlessly smooth Geoffrey Fernando, the ever-energetic Clifford Richard, musical genius Rukshan Perera, the dynamic Damian Wikramatillake, and dazzling Falan Andrea, who brings a new-age edge to the lineup. Together, they will deliver a spectacular set list that transcends generations.

And what's a party without a beat? The night's pulse will be driven by two of Sri Lanka's most-loved bands — Flame and AROH — bringing non-stop, heart-thumping performances that will have everyone from the disco kings to the Gen Z dancers lighting up the floor. As midnight draws near, the energy will crescendo to a dazzling countdown, setting the stage for a brand-new year in true Cinnamon Life fashion — bold, beautiful, and brimming

with joy. Guests can indulge in a sumptuous gourmet buffet spanning international favourites and local delights, before ending the night (or starting the morning!) with a comforting traditional Sri Lankan breakfast as 2026 dawns over Colombo's skyline. With glitz, glamour, and a dash of golden-age groove, "Dancing through the Decades" promises to be the most happening New Year's Eve party in town.

Tickets are priced at LKR 35,000 per person, with tables for 10 available. For reservations call +94 77 962 8132

So gather your friends, dust off those dancing shoes, and get ready to turn back time while stepping into the future, only at Cinnamon Life's "Dancing through the Decades". Because when Colombo celebrates, it celebrates here!

Sri Lanka's 2025 New Year's Eve celebrations include large and medium-scale events widely across the country according to information from the hospitality industry. Large scale events are scheduled at almost all luxury tourist hotels and several small and medium events are in line at pubs, restaurants and some hotels.

Hotel-based parties will feature live music and galas. Many hotels across the island will host their own events, often including dining and entertainment. Other hotels, restaurants, and clubs across the island will host their own events. Negombo, there will be some theme nights like 80s/90s retro parties or DJ nights. Beachside parties are also a popular option this 2025 based on reports we received from respective coastal areas. Mirissa, Hikkaduwa, and Unawatuna are popular for beach parties.

New Year's Eve refers to the evening, of the last day of the year - 31 December. It is also known as Old Year's Day. In many countries, New Year's Eve is celebrated with dancing, eating, drinking, and watching or lighting fireworks. Let's dance, dine, and celebrate together as we bid farewell to 2025 and welcome the New Year with music, joy, and unforgettable memories. Ring in the New Year with an unforgettable celebration that blends elegance, joy, and the excitement of new beginnings. 🎉

Numerous clubs and restaurants across the country, will have their own parties with DJs, cocktails, and special menus.

New Year's Eve celebration at Waters Edge will be with the legendary Mariani! 🎉 There's a delicious Gala Dinner, followed by a Breakfast Buffet to kick-start the New Year! 31st Dec 2025 at 8 PM onwards, The Grand Ballroom, Waters Edge.

Step into 2026 with Style & Rhythm at Ligness Green Odyssey for the most awaited 31st Gala Dinner featuring the sensational band DADDY live from 8 PM onwards! Enjoy a night of fine dining, live music, fireworks, and unforgettable moments under the stars. The evening will begin with a delightful locally crafted New Year's punch and an assortment of exquisite canapés, setting the tone for a night to remember. Immerse yourself in a unique cultural show that showcases the richness of our heritage. Indulge in a lavish multi-course Gala Dinner, expertly prepared by talented chefs, offering a culinary journey that tantalizes the senses.

AWAIT FOR MORE UPDATES. KEEP VIEWING US! www.lankatourguide.lk



Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts has extended its wellness concept to the southern coast with the introduction of Kurundu Wellness at Cinnamon Bentota Beach - Signature Selection, following its successful debut at Cinnamon Life at City of Dreams, Colombo.

The newly opened Kurundu Wellness Spa at Cinnamon Bentota Beach is operating as a well-regarded outlet according to customer comments. The feedback highlights the friendly staff, relaxing environment, and the spa's range of holistic treatments.

Guests frequently praise the warm and attentive services of the staff for their professionalism and hospitality, with many individual employees receiving special mentions for their service.

Reviewers describe Kurundu as a "sanctuary" and a place to "restore and renew" noting the serene ambiance and holistic offerings for its relaxing and rejuvenating atmosphere.

Remarks also highlight excellent facilities of the spa, describing as having great facilities, with positive comments on the treatments and therapies available.

The tranquil, wellness-focused environment is highly rated by guests seeking a peaceful and restorative experience.

There is no evidence of widespread or consistent complaints regarding the outlet, but most feedback being very positive.

Johan Aschan, General Manager of Cinnamon Bentota Beach – Signature Selection, stated:

"The launch of Kurundu Wellness at Cinnamon Bentota Beach – Signature Selection marks a significant enhancement to our resort's wellness proposition. Establishing our own wellness identity allows us to offer authentic, locally inspired experiences that meet the expectations of today's traveler. This initiative further strengthens our resort's position as a destination for relaxation, rejuvenation, and mindful living"

Cinnamon Wellness Concept Reaches South

Kurundu Wellness Spa

officially launched at Cinnamon Bentota Beach—Signature Selection recently focused on holistic wellness. The spa is positioned as an escape rooted in natural richness and traditional wellness, offering tailored rituals, aromatherapy, and other holistic therapies. The spa is a key feature of the Cinnamon Bentota Beach resort, which itself is celebrated for its stunning beachfront location, beautifully designed facilities, and excellent service. Named after the Sinhalese word for "Cinnamon" Kurundu is the brand's dedicated wellness concept that combines Ayurvedic principles with elements of Traditional Chinese Medicine (TCM). Operated under the theme "Wellness by Choice" it aims to provide structured and personalised wellness

experiences supported by locally inspired practices.

The new facility at Cinnamon Bentota Beach – Signature Selection includes:

- Two Signature Wellness Suites, each featuring a private relaxation pavilion and jacuzzi.
- A Thai Massage Room, offering traditional Thai therapies.
- A Manicure and Pedicure Room, designed for restorative care.
- Access to an expansive Wellness and Relaxation Area with a sauna, steam room, jacuzzi, and cold plunge showers for a complete thermal and hydrotherapy experience.

Treatments incorporate locally sourced botanicals and cinnamon-based therapies, complemented by programmes that integrate movement, mindfulness, and nutrition. As part of its continued development at Cinnamon Bentota Beach - Signature Selection, the Kurundu Wellness will expand its offering with specialised wellness packages and extended-stay programs in the coming months. These will include targeted wellness journeys tailored to individual guest needs, alongside collaborative retreats with visiting practitioners and experts. The expansion highlights the resort's commitment to evolving into a comprehensive wellness destination on Sri Lanka's southern coast.

Kurundu is available for reservations, with contact details provided through Cinnamon's social media and website.

Cinnamon Bentota Beach – Signature Selection is a five-star resort recognised for its architectural design inspired by the work of Geoffrey Bawa located on Sri Lanka's southern coastline. The property features 159 rooms, including 16 suites, multiple dining venues, and recreational spaces designed to reflect the region's cultural and natural heritage. The resort operates under Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts' Signature Selection brand, which focuses on delivering refined hospitality through design, service, and experience.

- Dinali Ruhunuwewa

Johan Aschan





Sri Lanka promotes tourism in Australia and New Zealand.

Sri Lanka Tourism Showcases its Potential as a Top Travel Destination at Roadshows in Australia and New Zealand.

SLTPB – Colombo | November 1 | www.lankatourguide.lk | Sri Lanka Tourism Promotion Bureau (SLTPB) recently demonstrated the island nation's tourism potential through a series of successful roadshows in Australia and New Zealand, highlighting Sri Lanka as a premier travel destination for international travelers. The promotional tour commenced on 13th October in Sydney, Australia, with the presence of Ms. Yasoja Gunasekara, Sri Lanka's High Commissioner to Australia, Buddhika Hewawasam, Chairman of SLTPB, and Ravindran V., Regional Manager – Asia Pacific Region, Sri Lankan Airlines Ltd. Fifty Sri Lankan companies participated alongside seventy-five Australian travel operators and media representatives. The event provided an invaluable platform for knowledge exchange, business discussions, and potential collaborations between Sri Lankan and Australian tourism stakeholders. On 15th October, the roadshow continued in Brisbane at Hotel Sofitel, attracting over 52

Australian travel trade companies and 15 media representatives and influencers. Ms. Gunasekara delivered the opening remarks, followed by a keynote from Hewawasam outlining Sri Lanka's renewed global tourism positioning. Ravindran V. highlighted airline connectivity, reinforcing the ease of travel between the two nations. Adding cultural vibrancy to the event, a traditional Sri Lankan dance performance captivated attendees. The final leg of Sri Lanka Tourism's promotional roadshow in Australia was successfully held on 20th October at the Hotel Chadstone in Melbourne, marking a significant milestone in strengthening tourism ties between the two nations.

The event attracted 83 Australian travel agents and 15 media representatives, showcasing Sri Lanka's growing appeal as a preferred travel destination in the region. The program commenced with a series of B2B meetings, providing an excellent platform for networking and fostering valuable business partnerships between Sri Lankan Destination Management Companies (DMCs), hoteliers, and Australian travel trade partners.

Ms. Predeepa Seram, Sri Lanka's Consul General in Melbourne highlighted the island's rich and diverse tourism offerings from pristine beaches and heritage sites to wildlife and wellness tourism while underscoring the strategic importance of collaboration with the Australian travel industry.

In addition, Mr. Ranvidran addressed the

gathering, focusing on the importance of enhancing direct air connectivity between Sri Lanka and Australia to facilitate greater travel convenience and tourism growth. The Melbourne roadshow concluded the successful Australian series, reinforcing Sri Lanka's position as one of the most promising and attractive travel destinations for Australian travelers.

Marking a historic milestone, Sri Lanka Tourism extended its global promotional campaign to New Zealand for the very first time, hosting a successful roadshow at Hotel Cordis in Auckland on 22nd October. The event aimed to strengthen tourism ties between the two island nations and showcase Sri Lanka's diverse travel offerings to the New Zealand market.

The evening commenced with opening remarks by Prasanna Gamage, Sri Lanka's High Commissioner to New Zealand, who emphasized the strong cultural connections and the growing potential for tourism collaboration between the two countries. It was highlighted the strategic importance of the New Zealand market for Sri Lanka's tourism industry, noting the country's increasing appeal among adventure seekers and long-haul travelers. Speakers further elaborated on airline connectivity between Sri Lanka and New Zealand, underscoring future possibilities for direct and connecting routes to enhance accessibility.

- Claude Gunasekera

KANDY MYST BY CINNAMON ACHIEVES PIONEERING LEED GOLD CERTIFICATION IN THE CITY

The newly opened Kandy Myst by Cinnamon hotel located in Kandy is the first in the city to receive LEED Gold certification, setting a new standard for sustainable hospitality in Kandy. The hotel's eco-friendly design includes significant water and energy conservation, high construction waste diversion, and green spaces. This award highlights the hotel's commitment to environmental stewardship and responsible development, which is expected to influence future projects in the region.

Kandy Myst by Cinnamon, the newest addition to the Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts portfolio developed in partnership with Indra Traders Ltd., has become the first hotel in Kandy to be awarded the prestigious LEED (Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design) Gold certification under the globally recognised LEED v4 Building Design and Construction (BD+C) rating system. This milestone reflects the hotel's strong commitment to advancing sustainability, protecting the environment, and fostering the well-being of its guests and community.

Energy Solve International CEO Mahendra Jayalath said: *"Kandy Myst by Cinnamon is the first hotel in Kandy to receive the LEED Gold certification, reflecting the power of sustainable design and execution. From energy-efficient systems to water re-use and green construction practices, this project demonstrates setting a new standard for sustainable hospitality in Sri Lanka. We are proud to have partnered with Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts"*



The principal design consultant for the project was Design Team 3 from Singapore, while the execution was carried out under a Design and Build contract by Nawaloka Construction Company Ltd. The project adhered to stringent quality standards and complied with the requirements of the US Green Building Council, culminating in the prestigious LEED Gold certification. The certification reflects the hotel's successful integration of advanced green building strategies, guided by EnergySolve International Ltd., the sustainability consultant behind the project. Through innovative design and engineering, Kandy Myst by Cinnamon has established itself as a benchmark for eco-conscious hospitality in Sri Lanka.

Key sustainability highlights at Kandy Myst by Cinnamon:

Carbon and energy performance: 730 tons of CO2e avoided annually through high-efficiency HVAC, LED lighting, and advanced envelope design; 15% overall energy savings.

Water conservation: 16 million litres of water saved annually via rainwater harvesting, onsite wastewater treatment, and efficient plumbing fixtures, achieving a 50% reduction in potable water use.

Sustainable site strategies: 30% of the site dedicated to native green spaces, with heat island mitigation measures including reflective roofing and shaded parking.

Mobility and accessibility: EV charging stations, priority parking for low-emission vehicles, and easy access to public transport.

Construction and materials: Over 80% of construction waste diverted from landfill, extensive use of recycled materials, and strong pollution prevention measures.

Indoor environmental quality: Fresh air systems exceeding ASHRAE standards, low-

VOC materials, and optimal daylighting for occupant wellness.

Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts Chief Executive Officer Designate Hishan Singhawansa said: "At Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts, sustainability is not just a responsibility but a core part of our business philosophy.

Achieving LEED Gold certification for our latest hotel, Kandy Myst by Cinnamon, is a milestone that reinforces our commitment to building a future where responsible tourism and exceptional guest experiences go hand in hand."

With ESG principles embedded into its operations, Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts continues to champion responsible tourism, energy efficiency, and community empowerment across all its properties. Photo from left: Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts Vice President, Engineering and Projects Ashvin Cabraal, Manager, Engineering and Projects Ashvin Jayathanthan, Design Team 3 Project Architect Athula Amarasekera, Nawaloka Construction Company CEO/Director Kalana Alwis, Kandy Myst by Cinnamon General Manager Dhinal Perera, EnergySolve International CEO Mahendra Jayalath, Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts Area General Manager, Central and East Sri Lanka Resorts Murfad Shariff and Director, Sales and Marketing Shavinda Jinadasa

The Federation of Sustainable Tourism of Sri Lanka extends its congratulations to Kandy Myst by Cinnamon for its Eco-conscious practices and its outstanding green initiatives.


Federation of Sustainable Tourism



Hilton Colombo has redefined indulgence at home with its premium home delivery service through **Café Kai**, the hotel's signature artisan café. Guests can now enjoy a variety of exquisite creations from Hilton Colombo's kitchens in the comfort of their own homes. Café Kai at Hilton Colombo offers an irresistible selection of gourmet treats and savories, all crafted with the hotel's hallmark attention to detail. Sweet indulgences include Cheesecake with Blueberry Pie Filling and Cheesecake with Mixed Berry Pie Filling — elegant, creamy delights perfect for any occasion.

For those craving something savory, Café Kai presents an elegant range of platters — from Savories Platters filled with delicious bites to Sushi Platters and Sandwich Platters, ideal for sharing or entertaining guests. Each dish is prepared with premium ingredients and the distinctive flair that defines Hilton Colombo's culinary excellence. "Every dish from Café Kai is prepared fresh, packaged with care, and designed to deliver that signature Hilton touch, even beyond our doors." Customers can place their orders by simply calling **0112 492 492** to use Café Kai's takeaway and delivery service.

Hilton Colombo's mobile ordering system makes browsing, selecting, and purchasing effortless — right from your phone. Simply click on the link below and shop: <https://hccolombo1.wi-q.com/> With Hilton Colombo's central location in Colombo's business district, deliveries reach a wide range of neighborhoods swiftly, preserving the freshness and finesse that define the Hilton experience. Delivery within Colombo city limits is complimentary, while a nominal fee applies for areas beyond. Each order is elegantly packaged, echoing the hotel's dedication to quality in every detail. Hilton Colombo's home delivery service through Café Kai blends culinary artistry with cutting-edge convenience, turning everyday dining into a moment of indulgence. Whether it's a weekend treat or a thoughtful gift, the hotel invites you to experience the excellence of Hilton Colombo — anywhere, anytime. Hilton Colombo Residences also does offer home delivery service across Colombo. Few other five-star hotels in Colombo are operating gourmet home-delivery services successfully.



Cinnamon Grand Colombo & Cinnamon Lakeside Colombo's online delivery platform is called "**Flavours by Cinnamon**". The Cinnamon brand covers multiple restaurants under one hotel and offers many cuisine types via the delivery platform. Their announcement highlights bringing "five-star meals right to your doorstep" and emphasizes quality, safety and broad variety of cuisines. The menu is diverse: Sri Lankan, Indian, Thai, Chinese, seafood, cakes/desserts, family meals etc. Minimum order is Rupees 5,000 for some categories. The offerings are clearly positioned as premium (five-star comfort at home) rather than just typical fast-food delivery according to Hotel.

The Kingsbury, Colombo offers an online delivery service — **The Kingsbury Indulgence**, Experience Five-star dining at Home with The Kingsbury Indulgence. For those who wish to savour the signature flavours of The Kingsbury in the comfort of home, The Kingsbury Indulgence offers an elevated five-star dining experience delivered straight to your doorstep. Blending gourmet craftsmanship with convenience, it brings the essence of the hotel's world-class dining to your table. Renowned for its culinary excellence, The Kingsbury Colombo brings the same standards of quality, safety and service that define its restaurants to your home through its dedicated online delivery platform, Indulgence. Featuring a diverse selection of cuisines, from Sri Lankan, Indian, Chinese, Thai and Western favourites to family meals, freshly baked pizzas, and decadent desserts, the platform caters to every palate and occasion. Each order is freshly prepared by expert chefs, with deliveries handled exclusively by The Kingsbury's own trained staff, ensuring the same trust, warmth and professionalism associated with the revered five-star hotel. Available daily from 11.30 a.m. to 10.30 p.m., The Kingsbury Indulgence also offers gift vouchers, perfect for special occasions, celebrations or sharing a taste of luxury with your loved ones. For more information, visit indulgence.thekingsburyhotel.com or contact +94 771 087 754.

Green way to Getaway



SUSTAINABLE SRI LANKA

Inviting you to achieve uniqueness of Tourism Industry by advertising in an exclusive sustainable tourism news & features portal in Sri Lanka – the print and online magazine focused on authentic, narrative-driven content that highlights the country's cultural and natural experiences of local communities and entrepreneurs, demonstrating how travel directly contributes to conservation and well-being, rather than simply listing attractions.

We provide storytelling to connect with local and international travelers' desire for mindful, impactful experiences and to differentiate Sri Lanka from competitors by showcasing its unique eco-initiatives. We also feature stories from local communities and entrepreneurs involved in sustainable tourism, showcasing their transformative experiences and contributions to the industry. We also go beyond visuals to multisensory branding: highlighting the sounds, tastes, and unique "feel" of Sri Lanka's natural and cultural environments, which fosters a stronger connection with potential visitors.

We present tangible examples of how travelers can make a positive impact.

One of our main purpose is to promote the National Sustainable Tourism Certification (NSTC) to build credibility and demonstrate Sri Lanka's commitment to sustainable practices, attracting conscious travelers. We support the hospitality industry in Sri Lanka to connect with Global Goals, thereby, frame sustainability efforts in the context of larger, universal goals, such as contributing to the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). While promoting wildlife and nature we focus on the "responsible and meaningful encounters" with wildlife and the educational aspects of these experiences. We use vivid imagery and descriptions to showcase the diversity of Sri Lanka, from pristine beaches to lush mountains and unique ecosystems, as a way to offer "un-missable experiences".

We invite tourism industry partners to join hands with this mission through your advertising support in order to continue this important national effort successfully.

ADVERTISING RATES

Rates effective only for (September - Decemeber 2025)

Please note advertising rates will be revised in January 2026

Double Page Colour – Centre Spread	: (LKR) Rs.100,000.00
Full Page Colour – Back Cover	: (LKR) Rs. 50,000.00
Full Page Colour – Inner Back Cover	: (LKR) Rs. 40,000.00
Full Page Colour – Front Inner Cover	: (LKR) Rs. 45,000.00
Full Page Colour – Inside Page	: (LKR) Rs. 25,000.00
Half Page is 60% of Full Page – Only Inside Pages	
Quarter Page is 35% of Full Page – Only Inside Pages	
Advertisement for 3 months contract – 30% Off	
Advertisement for 2 months contract – 15% Off	

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National Craft Council Unveils Dynamic Initiative to Promote Heritage and Engage Tourists

The National Craft Council (NCC) announced a major new strategic initiative designed to celebrate and promote the nation's rich heritage said Dr. Ayesha Wickramasinghe Chairperson National Crafts Council of Sri Lanka at a press conference held at Galle Face Hotel, Colombo.

The program will feature a series of re-launched and new activities aimed at both preserving traditional crafts and significantly boosting the market for artisan products among the country's growing influx of international tourists.

Central to this initiative is the revitalization of key programs that have proven successful in the past. These will be relaunched with enhanced features to maximize their impact and effectiveness. Activities will include: Revitalized National Craft Fairs: Upgraded and marketed as premier cultural events, these fairs will provide a vibrant platform for artisans to showcase and sell their work.

"Heritage in the Making" Workshop Series: Interactive workshops where tourists and locals can learn basic techniques directly from master artisans.

Enhanced Digital Showcase: A new and improved online platform featuring an e-commerce portal, virtual tours of artisan workshops, and compelling stories about the crafts and their creators.

A key focus of this strategy is the targeted promotion of authentic artisanary products to the heavy inflow of tourists. The NCC will collaborate with SLTDA, THASL, and travel agencies to integrate these cultural products into the core visitor experience. This includes establishing dedicated craft hubs in high-traffic tourist areas and creating "Meet the Artisan" tour packages.

"The soul of our nation is woven into the crafts our people create," said Dr. Ayesha Wickramasinghe. "This initiative is more than an economic program; it's a bridge connecting our proud heritage with the world. By making these unique, handcrafted products accessible and appealing to tourists, we ensure our traditions are not only preserved but also thrive for generations to come."

The National Craft Council is confident that this multi-pronged approach will provide sustainable income for artisan communities, enrich the tourist experience, and solidify the nation's reputation as a global destination for culture and authenticity.

The National Craft Council is the official body dedicated to the preservation, promotion, and development of the nation's traditional crafts and artisan sector.

Go behind the scenes at our artisan workshops. Discover unique, handcrafted treasures at new tourist hubs. Experience the Culture: Immerse yourself in the stories woven into every product. Whether you're a local or a tourist, get ready to explore our heritage like never before. Stay tuned for updates!

Contact: M.D.R. Prasad, Director National Craft Council for any joint programme towards the promotion of arts and crafts of Sri Lanka.

Sri Lanka shows its colors in Netherlands



LankaTourGuide | Colombo | Nov.28.2025 | Sri Lanka Tourism, in collaboration with the Embassy of Sri Lanka in The Hague, had the opportunity of showing that it's a travel destination visiting at least for once in a lifetime, which spread the island destinations 'uniqueness all across the European Region, participating at the Embassy Festival held recently in The Hague, Netherlands. The Sri Lanka stall was a tremendous success, making a notable impression at the festival mesmerizing the Dutch, and attracting a significant number of visitors, with its vibrant Tourism Products, Cultural Performances, live Culinary experiences and promotional videos. Many who visited the Sri Lankan stall expressed their keen interest in taking a look Sri Lankas promotional items , including handicrafts with their eye catching colors , spicy aroma of the herbs and authentic Sri Lankan cuisine , and getting a chance to take a sip of the world renowned Ceylon tea. The cultural items included a stage performance showcasing Sri Lankas rich cultural heritage, which added more glamour and color to the occasion. The Embassy festival is an annual cultural occasion and a Tourism Promotional event in The Hague, The Netherlands, providing Diplomatic missions with a valuable platform to

present the rich cultural diversity, heritage and tourism opportunities of their respective countries to Dutch and International travelers. This spectacular event was held for the 4th consecutive year, and this year's Embassy



participation of 46 embassies and international organizations . The event welcomed more than

70,000 visitors and offered a platform to showcase Sri Lankas rich heritage, cuisine, crafts, music and dance to ensure more tourist arrivals to the destination and enabling the visitors to add Sri Lanka to their bucket list of travel destinations.

The main objective of Sri Lanka taking part in this festival was to uplift the country's profile as a travel destination, promoting its capacity as a travel destination, it's world renowned warmth and hospitality, and the importance of having easy accessibility as a 365-day destination along with a myriad of exclusive travel opportunities, ranging from a walk on the sun kissed beaches down south to exploring the misty mountains, added by the lush greenery of the upcountry tea estates. Sri Lanka's wellness Tourism, including Sri Lanka's refreshing Ayurveda therapy was also a notable attraction at this event. The visitors thoroughly enjoyed the Sri Lankan cuisine and visitors praised the authenticity and the cultural beauty of the pavilion that reflected the beauty of the tourist attractions in the country. The Sri Lanka pavilion proved to be an eye catcher with many visitors curious to see what Sri Lanka had to offer and gain more information about Sri Lanka.

With this successful participation, The Netherlands have been identified as an important source market for Sri Lanka, and given the necessary promotion and recognition, it will provide the opportunity of increasing the number of tourist arrivals.



Travel Journalists Alliance Founder /
Elect Secretary Claude Gunasekera
addressing the Media Colleagues



Travel Journalists Alliance Launched to Strengthen Tourism in Sri Lanka

Colombo, Sri Lanka – The inaugural meeting of the Travel Journalists Alliance (TJA) of Sri Lanka marked the formation of a pioneering collective of media professionals dedicated to promoting Sri Lanka's tourism industry across multiple platforms.

Conceptualised by veteran journalist Claude Gunasekera, the Alliance brings together editors, writers, and content creators representing mainstream Newspapers, International Travel Publications, Digital Platforms, Websites and other Social Media Channels.

This marks the first-ever initiative in Sri Lanka uniting travel and tourism-related media professionals under one umbrella, with the shared goal of elevating Sri Lanka's visibility as a global travel destination. The Alliance aims to foster collaboration, ethical journalism, and sustainability-focused storytelling that highlights the island's diverse tourism offerings and growing appeal among international travellers.

Speaking on the initiative, Claude Gunasekera, Founder of the Travel Journalists Alliance, stated, "This Alliance represents a new chapter for travel journalism in Sri Lanka. By working together, we can share stories that not only inspire travel but also reflect responsible and ethical reporting. Our focus is on sustainability, authenticity, and promoting Sri Lanka's tourism with integrity across every medium."

At the inaugural meeting, the founding members appointed the first committee of the Travel Journalists Alliance, comprising leading names in Sri Lanka's media landscape: President: Sanath Weerasuriya – Travel Editor, Sunday Times, Vice Presidents: M. Rasooldeen – Chief Editor, Colombo Times Dinushka Chandrasena – Chief Editor, Travel Talk Asia, Geethika Weerakoon – Chief Editor, Serendib News, Secretary: Claude Gunasekera – Chief Editor, Lankapuvath International News Agency / TOURGUIDE / Journalist Daily News, Asst. Secretaries:

Daily News, Enoka Perera – Business Editor, Silumina Treasurer: Zanita Careem – Travel Editor, Sunday Island, Asst. Treasurer: Buddhika Brahmanage – Business Editor, Dinamina, Committee Members; Head of Digital (English): Melkishiya Andrew – Journalist, The Morning, Head of Digital (Sinhala): Harindi Liyanage – Chief Editor, Navaliya, Head of PR: Nelum Buddhadasa Journalist Newsasia, Steve Morell - Deputy Business Editor, Daily Island.

Virosh Perera – Director Serendib News was elected as Patron.

The Travel Journalists Alliance aims to serve as a unified voice for Sri Lanka's travel media community, creating synergies between traditional journalism and news media while ensuring accurate, engaging, and responsible content that supports the nation's tourism objectives.

The main objective is to promote excellence in travel journalism through a community of professional writers, photographers, and bloggers and support its members by providing professional benefits like fostering connections, and dedicated to promoting high standards and excellence in travel journalism. It serves as a professional body for travel media professionals, offering networking opportunities. It also provides a platform for its members to connect and share information, which is particularly useful in the current working environment.

TJA ensures members uphold a code of conduct, and its rigorous accreditation process verifies the quality and credibility of its members. The Alliance fosters partnerships with Tourism Authorities, Associations and other travel industry stakeholders, often through organized forums and conventions. The TJA plays a role in shaping the narrative of the travel industry by highlighting destinations and experiences to a wide audience of potential travelers.

Inaugural Meeting of TJASL Hosted by Cinnamon Grand Colombo



Travel Journalists Alliance thank Cinnamon Grand Colombo for hosting the TJASL Meeting



FEEL AN AMAZING EXPERIENCE AT IMMERSIVE 7DEGREE IN COLOMBO

Immerse in a fully immersive experience, so expected to be "transported to a different world" through the advanced technology used at a unique, immersive dining experience in Colombo. Visit Sri Lanka's first Immersive Restaurant, 7Degrees, which uses projectors, sensors, and Dolby Atmos sound to create a multi-sensory culinary journey for a small group. This fine-dining experience is designed by the renowned hospitality expert Nalin Malwenna, Managing Director of H.O.T. Travels. Executive Chef Patrick Velans offers a captivating blend of technology and gourmet cuisine, with themes that change to transport diners to different worlds.

You can expect a unique experience at Immerse, with a multi-sensory journey. Immerse goes beyond typical dining by engaging all your senses through visual, auditory, and olfactory elements. The high-tech advanced technology provides the space equipped with projectors, sensors, and a Dolby Atmos sound system to create dynamic environments. You can also enjoy themed experiences with multi-course menu curated to fit a changing theme for the evening, with each dish presented alongside its own audio-visual display to enhance the experience.

The restaurant will accommodate a limited number of guests, making it a unique and exclusive experience. If you wish to experience this exceptional opportunity make a reservation any day of the week by calling +94 112 559 222. 7Dedree Immerse is located at No.270, Park Road, Colombo 05.

Considerations for a First-Time Experience, given its unique nature and limited capacity, booking your spot in advance is much better. Communicate Your Occasion:

If you're planning a special event, such as a proposal, note that the restaurant can play your own photos and videos upon request.



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